

Exam #1 Study Guide

Concepts:

- **Typology** - America is predestined for greatness - John Winthrop's "City upon a Hill"
- **Puritan Declension** - Weakened faith and questioning of the theological doctrine by Puritans
- **American Exceptionalism** - Tied to typology, the belief that America is a nation of mentally and morally superior people
- **American Enlightenment** - An extension of the European Enlightenment movement, in which distrust in monarchical gov'ts grew and John Locke established the idea of natural rights
- **Lockean Natural Rights** - The belief in a human right to life, liberty, and property
- **Virginia Plan** - Plan schemes at Constitutional Convention by James Madison to establish strong, 3-branch government
- **New Jersey Plan** - Another Constitutional Convention plan for a unicameral/one chamber legislature akin to Articles of Confed. - led to Great Compromise
- **Connecticut/Great Compromise** - 1787 agreement establishing bicameral legislature (House of Reps & Senate)
- **Federalists** - Early supporters of the Constitution (Hamilton, John Jay, James Madison) who wrote 85 essays urging its adoption
- **Anti-Federalists** - Led by Patrick Henry, Federalist opposition who favored strong state gov't and feared federal gov't would lead to monarchy
- **Republicanism** - Political ideology focused on placing power in the hands of the people and elected representatives
- **3/5ths Compromise** - 1787 Constitutional agreement counting 3/5 of a state's enslaved population
- **Positive Freedom** - The right to act on one's will - "freedom to"
- **Negative Freedom** - The prevention of infringement on one's positive freedoms - "freedom from"
- **Individualism** - An ideology placing value in the rights/will of the individual over the collective demands of the state
- **Equality of Conditions** - A social concept aiming for equal opportunity regardless of starting point
- **Tyranny of the Majority** - When political/social majorities form, the oppression of the rights/interests of minority groups
- **Jacksonian Democracy** - Led by President Andrew Jackson, a political movement championing the common man & expanding voting rights for white men
- **Republican Motherhood** - A social movement promoting the civic role of mothers in raising patriotic and virtuous citizens
- **Doctrine of Separate Spheres** - The concept of women staying in a domestic role while men serve as laborers

Short Essay Topics:

- **Debates from the Constitution** - Great Compromise (Virginia/NJ plan), Tyranny of the Majority (Brutus No. 1/Federalist No. 10)
- **Themes from the Course** - American Exceptionalism (Winthrop/Crèvecoeur), "equal" inequality (3/5ths Comp/Doctrine of Sep. Spheres), Individualism (Locke/Tocqueville)
- **Comparing/contrasting Authors** - Crèvecoeur vs Tocqueville, Madison vs Brutus, Declaration of Sentiments vs Independence